Midterm Feedback

STAT 220B

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What you asked me to improve

Thanks for the thoughtful responses. 8 of 10 of you wrote in. Here are the themes that came up across multiple responses.

- **Pacing in Weeks 2 to 4.** Week 2 was light, and the catch-up afterward felt rushed.
- **Homework length.** Assignments have been long and math-heavy, leaving little time to practice the concepts the exam tests.
- **Worked examples.** More problems walked through on the board from scratch, with the thought process explained, would help.
- **Slide density.** When a full example is on screen, it can be hard to follow which part I am explaining.
- **Tying things back together.** A "step back" at the end of a topic to connect it to what came before.
- **Specific concepts.** Bayes machinery, improper priors, utility theory, and notation for which expectation we are taking.

What I will do

I take the feedback seriously. The Week 2 disruption was my responsibility, and the pacing problems that followed are on me. Here is what changes from here.

- **Pacing.** I will not compress materials. If we cannot cover something fully in class, I will give you detailed notes on it (like the supplementary notes on the hyperplane theorems and the Minimax Theorem).
- **Homework.** I will keep length in mind when I set up HW4. A question for the room: **HW3 is due at the end of this week, and HW4 will be due the week after. Do you think an extension on HW3 would be useful?**
- **Worked examples.** At least one example each lecture worked on the board from scratch, with the slide hidden until afterward.
- **Slides.** Examples on slides will be revealed step by step rather than all at once.
- **Tying back.** Each lecture will end with a "step back" slide connecting today's material to earlier topics.
- **Specific concepts.** I will handout cheatsheet that traces the flow of the course so far: how the pieces connect, what notation we use where, and which results depend on which. Notation tagging ($\mathbb{E}_{P_\theta}$ vs $\mathbb{E}^\pi$) continues from now on.